



Matrix Comsec's time attendance and access control solution

movement of unauthorised people.

The three types of sensors used in the motion detection spectrum are passive infrared (PIR), ultrasonic and microwave sensors. These sensors send out pulses that measure the reflection of a moving object. Buttons can be used to release a lock or activate a door-opening sequence based on the situation.

One of the latest innovations from Honeywell is LobbyWorksTM 4.0. This device is well-suited for commercial and office building visitor management, which acts as the first line of security and access control. "Having the ability to screen and track the large footfall on a day-to-day basis contributes substantially to the access management and safety of personnel and property. With this device, the user can enhance lobby and security desk productivity by scanning business cards or drivers' licenses to quickly register visitors and provide voice coaching to guide visitors during the registration process. It also captures photos for new visitors and identifies returning visitors, thereby creating a bank of historical data for future use," informs Vikas Chadha.

However, the key trend is the movement to TCP/IP-based devices, which work directly with the existing infrastructure. "Today, buyers look for complete access control solutions. They want fully-functional

and completely adaptable software with simple installation methods that are user-friendly. We have recently launched our security products with access control and fire alarm systems and have received encouraging response from the market," explains Srikanth Pisapati.

Biometrics. Biometrics is the method of recognising a person based on his/her physiological and behavioural characteristics. Recognition of fingerprints, the iris, retina, face and hand geometry are the commonly used physiological characteristics for verification. Signature verification and voice verification use behavioural characteristics for authentication. This is the latest technological innovation in the personal domain.

The Indian biometrics market is currently dominated by fingerprint technology, while iris recognition is expected to be the technology of the future. Despite having vast potential, it is disheartening to know that India does not have many players in this seg-

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ment. The technology is generally borrowed from other leading countries. The launch of the UIDAI project has opened new avenues in this segment, as international players are now entering the domestic market and helping in deploying and installing biometric devices.

Manufacturing—a distant dream

Despite tremendous demand and various applications of security products, it is sad that the major players in this segment are international firms who have their manufacturing facilities outside the country. The picture on the manufacturing front doesn't seem positive. While the demand for security and surveillance devices is increasing rapidly, the country has just a handful of players who manufacture fingerprint machines, CCTV cameras and ACS devices.

"Manufacturing of security products in India is a big challenge as none of the components are available locally. We source 70 per cent of the components from other countries. Moreover, the grey market is another deterrent to our growth. Despite the demand however, there is negligible manufacturing of CCTVs within the country. The industry seems to be oblivious to the enormous potential of this sector and is content to source components from foreign countries like China. Instead of manufacturing, people prefer importing because the product is available at cheap rates outside India," says Sanjeev Sehgal.

One of the biggest reasons hampering domestic manufacturing of biometrics devices is that it is a high-end technology product, and India is at a nascent stage of exploring it. Moreover, the investment in research and development (R&D) for high-end devices is not well-supported by favourable government policies.

"There is a lot of perennial research and technological upgradation that has happened over the years in the West, especially the technological